

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM



Adam, center, waits along a wall with other students during his jujitsu class at Ground Rules Jiu Jitsu in Tinley Park on Sept. 25. Adam's parents and siblings were killed in Gaza last year and he was evacuated with his grandmother by Heal Palestine. **EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Habba serving unlawfully, court says

Ex-Trump lawyer's interim term expired as top NJ prosecutor

By Mike Catalini
Associated Press

PHILADELPHIA — President Donald Trump's former personal lawyer Alina Habba is disqualified from serving as New Jersey's top federal prosecutor despite his administration's maneuvers to keep her in the role, an appeals court said Monday.

A panel of judges from the 3rd U.S. Circuit Court of Appeals sitting in Philadelphia sided with a lower-court judge's ruling after hearing oral arguments at which Habba was present on Oct. 20.

"It is apparent that the current administration has been frustrated by some of the legal and political barriers to getting its appointees in place. Its efforts to elevate its preferred candidate for U.S. Attorney for the District of New Jersey, Alina Habba, to the role of Acting U.S. Attorney demonstrate the difficulties it has faced — yet the citizens of New Jersey and the loyal employees in the U.S. Attorney's Office deserve some clarity and stability," the court wrote in a 32-page opinion.

It concluded: "We will affirm the District Court's disqualification order."

The ruling comes amid the push by Trump's Republican administration to keep Habba as the acting U.S. attorney for New Jersey, a powerful post charged with enforcing federal criminal and civil law. It also comes after the judges questioned the government's moves to keep Habba in place after her interim appointment expired and without her getting Senate confirmation.

Habba said after that hearing in a statement that she was fighting on behalf of other candidates to be federal prosecutors who have been denied a chance for a Senate hearing.

The White House had no immediate comment on Habba on Monday and referred questions

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Somewhere safe

A child evacuated from Gaza finds a sense of normalcy in Tinley Park

By Zareen Syed | Chicago Tribune

A typical late afternoon for 4-year-old Adam is much like a typical late afternoon for any child his age: snacks, "Cocomelon" on YouTube, blocks, jumping off the stairs, resisting a bath.

But unlike most toddlers, Adam lives with a host family thousands of miles away from his hometown in Rafah, in the southern Gaza Strip. His parents were killed, his siblings, too. He also jumps off the stairs with just one leg, not two.

Adam is one of six children temporarily living in the Chicago area after being medically evacuated by Heal Palestine, an organization founded in response to the destruction caused in Gaza by Israel's response to the Oct. 7, 2023, attacks by Hamas. All of the children are amputees, with most of them staying in the southwest suburbs. Heal Palestine asked the Tribune not to disclose Adam's full name for security reasons.

Steve Sosebee, the founder of Heal Palestine, who has worked to medically evacuate children from war-torn countries for

over 30 years, said his organization helps patients in Gaza who have had an amputation and require specialized care. Heal Palestine also facilitates evacuations to other countries such as Mexico, Spain, Portugal and Italy.

"There's such a need that it's not a challenge to identify the patients — the challenge is to place them in care and to get them out," Sosebee told the Tribune.

The U.S. State Department halted visitor visas to the U.S. in August for individuals from Gaza — including for medical treatment — while it reviewed its visa-issuing

procedures. But Heal Palestine made it clear that the program is not for refugee resettlement. After their treatment is complete, these children and any accompanying family members will go to a location in the Middle East yet to be determined, Sosebee said.

When that time comes, it will be a bitter-sweet goodbye, said Tinley Park resident Tujan Almasri, who has been hosting Adam and his paternal grandmother since they arrived in April. Almasri and her family have grown attached to both visitors.

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Son of 'El Chapo' admits flying cartel boss to US

Guzmán López pleads guilty in Chicago trafficking case

By Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

One of the sons of Joaquín "El Chapo" Guzmán admitted for the first time in a Chicago courtroom Monday that he orchestrated the dramatic kidnapping of elusive Sinaloa cartel leader Ismael "El Mayo" Zambada in 2024 and delivered both himself and his quarry to U.S. authorities in the hopes of leniency.

In pleading guilty to narcotics trafficking charges, Joaquín Guzmán López offered new details in his shocking move to betray Zambada, which made global headlines and brought down one of the most wanted figures in the world.

According to his plea, Guzmán López arranged for a meeting in Sinaloa, Mexico, with Zambada — identified only as "Individual A" — by telling him he was needed to resolve a dispute. When Zambada arrived on July 25, 2024, Guzmán López brought him to a private room where he'd secretly removed the glass from a floor-to-ceiling window, according to the plea.

Once Guzmán López had closed and locked the door, armed men entered through the window and handcuffed Zambada and put a bag over his head, according to the plea. Zambada was then loaded into a pickup truck and driven to a nearby airstrip, where he was forced onto a private plane with Guzmán López, according to the plea.

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"This whole ideology with Chicago, I feel it. You love your city. I get it. You're passionate about that. I understand better now," said Darren Bailey, Republican candidate for governor, on Monday. **E. JASON WAMBSGANS/TRIBUNE**

Bailey returns to campaign

Humbled by tragedy, the Republican resumes his quest for Illinois governor

By Rick Pearson
Chicago Tribune

Less than two months after four family members died in a tragic helicopter crash, Darren Bailey finds himself not only trying to

rebuild his life but also his nascent campaign for the Republican nomination for Illinois governor.

After taking time off to grieve the loss of his son Zachary, daughter-in-law Kelsey and grandchildren Vada Rose, 12, and Samuel, 7, in the accident in southeastern Montana on Oct. 22 — and taking guardianship of another of the couple's children, Finn, 10, who was not on the aircraft — the downstate farmer and former state senator said Monday he is

returning to the campaign trail.

Humbled by a deep sense of personal loss and chastened by an outpouring of sympathy from both sides of the political aisle, Bailey said, "I just saw complete goodness. And you know why it surprised me? It surprised me because I, myself, haven't always been the best at that."

"I haven't always been diligent about expressing my sympathy,

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INSIDE

6 reasons Bears could have a great December

Coach Ben Johnson predicted in September the team would play their best football this month. Here's why that should come true. **Chicago Sports**

White House insists 2nd boat strike was legal

The Trump administration said the Navy admiral who ordered a follow-up strike on an alleged drug boat acted "within his authority." **Nation & World**